



Optical Disk Drives



The laser of your PC, the light of your data, Optical Disk Drives are often also the noise of your cabinet, the 'drive not ready' of your Explorer. ODD standards are going through a transition the world over, and in India, last year was clearly when CD-Writers replaced the read-only drives of yesteryear. Unfortunately, variable CD-Writer quality, plus the delicate sensitivity of the media, ensure that reading CDs is often a hit-and-miss affair.

Kartik Vithalani, who uses Samsung products, says, "I have been using the DVD-R for six months and the CD-RW for two years. No problems so far."

Sony tops in reliability, followed closely by Liteon. Samsung drives have the highest number of responses this year, accounting for over 40 per cent of the overall. They were also the worst of the lot.

While four per cent of Sony and five per cent of Liteon drives required replacement or major

Sony tops in reliability as well as service, followed closely by Liteon

repair, Samsung saw a whopping 14 per cent of their drives go back for servicing. They also scored the poorest in every other reliability parameter, coming in at the bottom of the qualifying brands.

Asus and Sony excelled at service, with the lowest rate of unresolved problems, and they also had the quickest turnaround times, indicating a solid support network. Samsung, on the other hand, with the largest rate of unresolved problems and a two-and-a-half-week turnaround time, was the poorest at service.

Sony

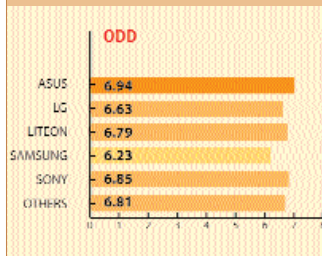
The Top Three

Sony	8.06
Liteon	8.01
Asus	8.01

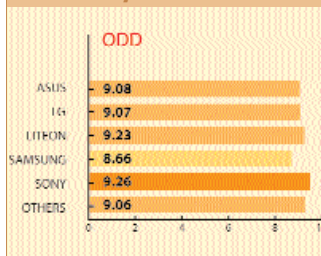
Repurchase Index (%)

LG	74
Liteon	73
Sony	73

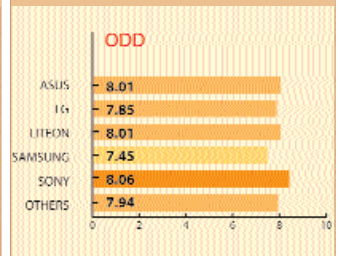
Satisfaction Index



Reliability Index



Overall



Creative



The Top Three

Creative	8.24
Intex	8.11
Philips	8.08

Repurchase Index (%)

Creative	87
Intex	71
Altec Lansing	71



PC Speakers

While they may not be as important as your monitor for 'real' computer tasks, they are quite the indispensable add-on these days. Despite the enormous range of variation in sound quality, affordable speakers are now good enough to serve adequately for occasional MP3 playback.

Brand loyalty is not very high though, with a multitude of affordable speaker vendors vying for your money.

Anurag Nagpal from Haryana says, "I have been using Intex for

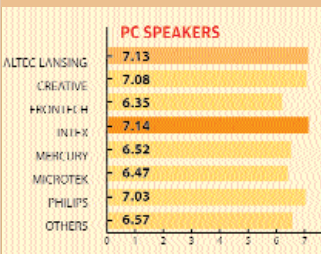
Brand loyalty is not very high, with a multitude of affordable speaker vendors vying for your money

seven years. Though there have been no problems, I feel Samsung has better sound quality than Intex. In the future, I will not buy from either company and go for Creative as I have heard it offers quality sound."

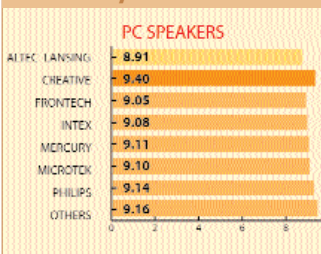
Being the relatively simple devices that they are, it is hardly a surprise to see that PC speakers have the lowest chances of early failure with an industry average of just one per cent, and the lowest rate of failure with fewer than two per cent needing servicing in two years.

Creative and Mercury have the lowest failure rates at two per cent. Intex and Altec Lansing share the highest rates of failure at over 11 per cent, but curiously, complement this by doing very well on service, posting the highest scores in this category.

Satisfaction Index



Reliability Index



Overall

